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[00:08:07] The House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to the privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:08:25] The members will rise and be led in prayer by Reverend Dr. Lisa M. Johnson of St. Paul's Baptist Church, Richmond, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance of the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Good morning. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Let us pray.

[00:08:46] Always an eternal, God, we pause this morning just to say thank you for the opportunity to be in this chamber. We thank you for the opportunity to lead your people in the state of Virginia. We thank you, God, that you trust us to be good to people, to be honest with people, to have compassion.

[00:09:05] And so now, God, I ask that you would allow your people in this chamber who will make the decisions for the people in Virginia to listen for your voice. Any decisions that are being made, we want to lean into Micah 6, verse 8, that says that we must be fair to other people, that we must be kind to other people, and that we must be careful to do what you've shown us to do.

[00:09:31] And so now, God, we ask that you would lead God, direct, give wisdom, clarity, and insight for every decision that is made on behalf of the people in the state of Virginia. We thank you for our speaker.

We ask that you would give him wisdom and insight as he leads and guides.

[00:09:49] Trust us with what you've assigned to our hands, God, and we promise that we will give your name the praise when it's all said and done. It's in the strong name of Jesus the Christ, our Redeemer, that we give you thanks. Amen. Amen. Let's allegiance to the flag of the United States of America, to the republic for indivisible.

[00:10:26] Members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:10:51] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the General House of Delegates for February 3rd, 2026. Motions and resolutions of the Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order.

[00:11:10] Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No announcements or communications at this time. Therefore, pursuant to House Rule 40, the speaker requests to use the request to speak button for the agenda items listed up for reference on the voting board. The delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise today for an introduction.

[00:11:29] The delegate has the floor. Thank you. Giving our invocation today is Reverend Dr. Lisa Johnson. I do ask that she please stand. Reverend Dr. Johnson is the Encore Life Stage Pastor at the St. Paul's Baptist Church and the former co-pastoral director at Richmond Hill, an urban echaemenical Christian retreat facility here in Richmond. A proud product of Richmond City Public Schools, Reverend Dr. Johnson dedicated 30 years to the district as an educator before retiring.

[00:12:01] She completed her undergraduate studies at Virginia State University and holds a Master of Divinity from Virginia Union University and a Doctor of Ministry degree in Counseling from Ashland Theological Seminary. Reverend Dr. Johnson serves on the Healing Care Team for the Healing Place Center for Christian Counseling, serves on the board of the Center for Workforce Inclusion, and is chaplain of the Henrico County Alumni Chapter of Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Incorporated.

[00:12:30] I want to thank her for giving out invocation today and ask that we give her a warm house welcome.

[00:12:44] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate, ask the floor. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, I would like to introduce to everyone John Jucuri. He's on the back there, if he could stand up.

[00:13:01] John is the Director of Development for the National Conference of State Legislatures, or NCSL. He's a great friend to the Commonwealth of Virginia. As a matter of fact, he lives in Alexandria and is a constituent of Delegate Paul Krasik and Senator Scott Surabell. Mr. Speaker, NCSL is a bipartisan organization for all state legislators and the legislative staff for the whole country, and they do a great job for us here in the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[00:13:26] I just want to welcome John to the chamber today. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Welcome, welcome. Welcome in, CSL. You saw the ones that stood up. They won a trip.

[00:13:43] The delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today we have our local office on aging advocates who are with us today. If I could ask them to please rise. The local office on aging in Roanoke has over 200 advocates from across the state.

[00:14:01] They are out today advocating as individuals who are trying to help those facing some difficult issues across Virginia. In our local community, they've been serving us for over 30 years. Their work is vital to creating a Virginia where older adults can live fulfilling and independent lives.

[00:14:20] I hope it be the pleasure of the body to give them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Lundenberg, Delegate Wright. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr.

[00:14:38] Speaker, I have a motion. The Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that HJR 11 be taken of order. It's on page 39 of today's calendar. Delegate from Lunenburg, Delegate Wright moves that we take H.J.R. 11 by without objection? No, take it up. Take it up? You want to take it up out of order. Okay, can I get it? Yes, sir. Clerk will report a resolution. Mr. Speaker, page 39 of today's calendar, House Joint Resolution 11, commending the Halifax South Boston Dixie Darlings softball team. That legislation H.J.R. 11 is now before you.

[00:15:08] Delegate from Lunenburg, Delegate Wright. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the resolution and I request to speak to the motion. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker and ladies and gentlemen of the House, HJR 11 recognizes an extraordinary group of young athletes from Halifax County.

[00:15:28] They are the 2025 World Series champions, the Halifax, South Boston, Dixie-Darling softball team. These young ladies represent not only their community but the very best of Virginia youth athletics.

[00:15:44] The Halifax South Boston Dixie Dawlings softball team made history as the first team from the Commonwealth to win the Dixie Softball Dawlings World Series on July 29, 2025. The Halifax South Boston Dixie Dawlings were the only team representing the Commonwealth in their age group at the Dixie Softball World Series and won five straight games in the double elimination style tournament.

[00:16:11] In the championship final, the Halifax South Boston Dixie Dolans faced the team from Ruston, Louisiana and dominated the game, winning 15-2 and claiming the World Series title. The successful season was a tribute to the hard work of the athletes Santana Barnett, Riley Clark, Avery Clements, Sadie Clements, Macy Cruz, Niari Davis, Kaylin Fauci, Olivia Gilliam, Bellamy McDowell, Mary Nell Roller, Bertie Wilkins, and Ava Worley.

[00:16:51] under the leadership of Head Coach Shane Fosche and Assistant Coaches Will Worley, Sam Gilliam, and Amanda McDowell. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen, this group panel being here today, however the conditions of the roads in their area prevented them from coming, but I would ask the House if they would give them a warm round of appreciation and show their congratulations.

[00:17:14] Join me in doing so, please. All those in favor of adopting House Joint Resolution 11, commending the Halifax South Boston Dixie-Darland South Ball Team, shall say aye.

[00:17:36] Those opposed, no. The resolution is adopted. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sebald. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise today for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today I have the honor of introducing Safe Spot Children's Advocacy Center of Fairfax County.

[00:17:55] I ask them to please rise. SafeSpot was founded in 2013 to respond to a painful reality that children experiencing abuse were often forced to navigate complex systems that added to their trauma. In response, community leaders created a child-centered place where healing could begin.

[00:18:17] Today, SafeSpot brings together law enforcement, child welfare professionals, advocates, and medical and mental health experts to ensure children are protected, supported, and believed. Please join me in welcoming the SafeSpot team to the House. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:18:43] Delegate from ACOMAC, Delegate Blossom. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate, that's the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Members of the House, today I have the pleasure of recognizing the Virginia Spaceport Authority who are visiting the Capitol in conjunction with the Virginia Aerospace Day, and I would ask them to rise if they're still in the gallery.

[00:19:07] Located on Virginia's beautiful eastern shore, the Virginia Spaceport Authority operates one of only four spaceports in the United States, making it truly unique to the Commonwealth and a national asset. The spaceport plays a critical role in advancing aerospace innovation, national security, and economic development while positioning Virginia as a leader in the rapidly growing commercial space industry.

[00:19:32] 2026 will be a banner year for the Authority with eight planned launches, the most ever in a single year, and approximately 30 launches planned over the next three years. All have an invite. Everyone in the room has an invite to the launch.

[00:19:49] Mr. Speaker, I ask the members of the House to join me in welcoming the Virginia Space Authority and join them at the airspace and aviation reception this evening at 530 at the Main Street Station. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:20:08] The delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House take up out of order H.R. 56, found on page 59 of today's calendar. Kirkwood, Port of Resolution. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, House Resolution No. 56, commending Campbell's Chapel African Methodist Episcopal Church, H.R. 56, now before you.

[00:20:33] Delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the adoption of the resolution, and I request to speak to the motion. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you. I rise today to recognize the 155th anniversary of Campbell's Chapel African Methodist Episcopal Church, and they have members in the gallery, if they would please rise.

[00:20:50] Awesome. Campbell's Chapel African Methodist Episcopal Church stands as a cornerstone of faith and resilience in the Carrollton community in Isla White County. Founded on February 8, 1870 by a group of newly freed men and women, this congregation has grown from its earliest days of worship under a bush harbor to becoming a vital pillar of fellowship and spiritual leadership.

[00:21:12] Throughout its storied history, the church has remained a beacon of hope and service, providing essential outreach throughout initiatives such as its food pantry, the Village Leaders, and the Dolores P. Wooten Women's Roundtable Ministry. Under the leadership of the Reverend Matthew Shannon, the church continues to thrive by embracing progress and technology, notably becoming the second in the Virginia Conference to install a digital marquee to better serve its neighbors.

[00:21:37] This anniversary is a testament to the enduring strength and grace of a church family whose journey has been marked by a steadfast dedication to God in the residence of Carrollton. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:21:58] The delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark, moves that we adopt House Resolution No. 556, commending Campbell's Chapel African Methodist Episcopal Church. All those in favor shall say aye.

[00:22:15] All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations. The delegate from Campbell, Delegate Zaire. Zaire? Zaire. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. You got it. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction.

[00:22:30] The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, previously Delegate Rasul recognized the Roanoke Area Agency on the Aging, but I am very partial to our own Central Virginia Alliance for Community Living. I believe they're in the balcony. And would you all please stand? These folks have traveled quite a distance.

[00:22:48] We honor them for their lived experience and the example they set for communities across our commonwealth. Their advocacy and their 50 years of work, strength, and independence, dignity, and quality of life for older Virginians. Please join me in recognizing the Central Virginia Area Council and their older adults in attendance today.

[00:23:15] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for two introductions. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. First, also to help us mark Virginia Aerospace Day, we are honored to have with us in the chamber volunteers from the Virginia Wing of the United States Air Force Auxiliary Civil Air Patrol.

[00:23:40] And if you are in the gallery, if I could ask you to rise. The Civil Air Patrol is established as an organization under Title IX of the United States Code, whose mission is a provision of emergency services, response, aerospace education, and cadet programs. I was a Civil Air Patrol cadet when I was young, and I can attest to the value of the cadet program, that it contributes to our youth, especially leadership development.

[00:24:02] These young cadets and senior members represent more than 2,000 Virginia volunteer members in 28 active units throughout Virginia. So please join me in welcoming these fine young men and women to the Capitol today. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:24:24] Delegate from Hanover. Delegate, follow. Mr. Speaker. Oh, one more. Sorry. One more, Mr. Speaker. So, Mr. Speaker and members of the body, I would also like to take a moment to welcome advocates from the Children Advocacy Centers of Virginia and local Children Advocacy Centers from across the Commonwealth who are joining us today.

[00:24:39] If you could please rise. Many members of this body are already familiar with CACs because they have visited their local center and seen their work firsthand. And some of our own members, like Delegate Margaret Franklin, have had the experience of working directly to establish a CAC in their community and understand personally what it takes to make these centers successful CACs are critical when a child becomes a victim of a crime they bring together law enforcement prosecutors child protective services and mental health professionals so investigations are stronger cases move forward and children are not re-traumatized by the system that is meant to protect them so i encourage you to visit a CAC when we are not in

[00:25:16] session and please join me in giving these CAC advocates a warm house welcome welcome welcome Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Hanover.

[00:25:32] Delegate Fowler. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I'll write for an announcement. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I hope the body will join Betsy Carr and myself in the morning for our Virginia Legislative Sportsman's Caucus meeting.

[00:25:53] We're going to meet at 7 a.m. I know that's early. The seventh floor, seventh floor House North Subcommittee room. Mr. Speaker, the special guest for this meeting is Mr. Mike Leonard, Vice President of the Government Affairs for the American Sport Fishing Association.

[00:26:13] Mr. Leonard will provide the caucus with an overview of the importance of conservation, species management, and Mr. Speaker in Recreational Fishing in the Commonwealth. Mr. Speaker, I hope you'll be able to join us, too. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from here, right, or Delegate Willett?

[00:26:34] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, as you've heard already from a couple of our colleagues, today is Older Virginians Advocacy Day at Capitol Square. Included in that group of advocates is the SPAN Center here in Richmond, and if they're still with us, please ask them to rise.

[00:26:53] The goal of today's activity is to bring together older adults, advocates, and state legislators to engage in meaningful discussion and support efforts that enable individuals to age at home and in the community. We have, as we mentioned, area agencies on aging from across the state.

[00:27:08] They've come together to amplify the voices of older adults and caregivers. Our aim is to ensure that every Virginian can age with dignity and choice. Please join me in giving them a warm House welcome. Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:27:29] Delegate from Giles County, Delegate Ballard. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of the House. Today is Radford University's Advocacy Day, and we have a special group of students visiting the Capitol and joining us in the gallery.

[00:27:46] I would ask that they please stand. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, I have the honor of representing Radford University, which is a public university in the New River Valley that was founded by the Virginia General Assembly in 1910 and currently enrolls over 7,800 students.

[00:28:03] Radford University is one of our most accessible and affordable public institutions in the Commonwealth. 92% of Radford undergrads are Virginians and 31% are first-generation college students. Mr. Speaker, the Radford University students who are with us here today come from all regions across the Commonwealth, and they shared their stories with many of you this morning.

[00:28:26] I hope it's the pleasure of the house to give the students and staff from Radford University a very warm house welcome. Welcome.

[00:28:43] Welcome to the Capitol. Y'all look good with those little red ties on, too. Y'all look good. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, joining us in the gallery today is the Substance Abuse and Addiction Recovery Alliance of Virginia, or SARA. Other recovery advocates from across Virginia are here to recognize Recovery Advocacy Day, and I'd ask that they'd please rise in the gallery if they can.

[00:29:12] So SARA of Virginia is celebrating 30 years of recovery advocacy across Virginia and leads the way in advocating, educating, and supporting individuals and families whose lives have been impacted by substance use disorder. Mr. Speaker, we know that substance use disorder is a chronic medical condition that affects people of all ages, incomes, and backgrounds. In Virginia alone, over 1 million residents are estimated to be living with SUD, and countless more have family members or friends who have been harmed by addiction. Today, we affirm that recovery is possible and that we must support policies that strengthen prevention, treatment, and recovery efforts for individuals and families affected by substance use disorder. Mr. Speaker, I hope it

[00:29:52] It is the pleasure of the body to offer these advocates from Sarah a very warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Montgomery County, Delegate Franklin.

[00:30:11] Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this morning we are joined by members of the Roanoke County government, including members of the Board of Supervisors and the school board. I ask that they rise. They're here today advocating for the Children's Services Act and public funds for in-house private day schools, as well as many other county issues.

[00:30:33] Please join me and the other Roanoke County area delegations in giving them a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Henrico, Delegate McQuinn.

[00:30:51] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of a motion. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that H.R. 55 on page 59 be taken up out of order.

[00:31:07] Clerk will report a resolution. House Resolution No. 55, celebrating the life of Frankie Jacqueline Scott and Joyner, Ph.D. Dr. Mariko. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the resolution and I request to speak to the motion. The delegate has the floor.

[00:31:23] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Dr. Jackie Joyner was an esteemed educator, mentor, woman of deep faith, a pillar of the Richmond community whose lifelong work profoundly impacted countless students, colleagues, families, and friends.

[00:31:43] Dr. Joyner was many things to many people. She was an educator who impact reached far beyond the classroom, a mentor who lifted others as she climbed, a community leader who served with purpose, and a woman of deep and abiding faith whose life reflected her values.

[00:32:01] Her commitment to service was unwavering, and her influence will be felt for generations. But today I rise to speak to this woman because she also was someone to me. She was not only a respected leader in our community, but she was my neighbor.

[00:32:20] She was my friend, my sister friend. Our relationship was not confined by meetings or public events. It was rooted in trust, care, and shared life. She was present in most meaningful moments of my family's journey, including the birthday and the birth of my grandchildren.

[00:32:39] In every sense of the word, she served as a surrogate godmother to them, offering love and guidance and spiritual grounding that only someone of her character could provide. Dr. Joanna believed deeply in education as a tool for empowerment and faith as a source of strength and a community as a responsibility we owe one another.

[00:33:02] She lived those beliefs every day, not for recognition, but because it was who she was. Mr. Speaker, this HR 55 honors not only Dr. Joyner's accomplishment, but the spirit in which she served.

[00:33:18] It recognizes a life devoted to uplifting others, nurturing the next generation, and leaving our community better than she found it. So I'm proud to support this resolution, and I'm grateful for the opportunity to ensure that Dr. Frankie Jacqueline Scott and Joyner's legacy is forever recorded in the history in this house.

[00:33:38] And so, Mr. Speaker, I ask that when we adjourn today, that we do this in memory of Franklin, Frankie, Jacqueline Sutton Joyner. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Enrico moves that we adopt House Resolution No. 55, celebrating the life of Frankie, Jacqueline, Scott, and Joyner.

[00:33:58] All those in favor shall please rise. The resolution is agreed to. The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:34:13] I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, following Delegates Zaire and Delegate Rasul, I also have an introduction for Older Virginia's Advocacy Day. Today in the gallery, we have advocates from the Jefferson Area Board on Aging, JABBA. I ask that they please rise at this time.

[00:34:32] JABBA supports Central Virginians, offering a wide range of services to meet the needs of older adults, individuals with disabilities, and their caregivers. Their dedication is a testament to the impact of Virginia's aging network, and I am proud to welcome them here today. I request that the members please join me in extending them a warm House welcome.

[00:34:53] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker and ladies and gentlemen of the House, joining us today in the gallery are a group of nuclear engineering students.

[00:35:12] I hope they are here and can rise. There they are. There they are. Mr. Speaker, these students are joining us from a number of universities, UVA, Virginia Tech, Liberty, and VCU. and they're here today as part of their annual American Nuclear Society Student Lobby Day.

[00:35:30] They're here today also with the Executive Director of the Virginia Nuclear Energy Consortium, whose stakeholders include the Commonwealth, institutions of higher education, nuclear energy companies, suppliers, and local organizations who support the advancement of the nuclear industry. We're glad to have these students from across the Commonwealth join us today, and I hope the body will join me in giving them a warm house welcome.

[00:36:00] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I move that House Bill 679, House Bill 679 on page 18 of the calendar, be re-referred to the Committee on Counties, Cities, and Towns.

[00:36:16] The delegate from Fairfax, Doug, it's time to move that HB 679 be re-referred on page 18, be re-referred to the Committee on Counties, Cities, and Towns. All those in favor, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. HB 679 is re-referred to Cities, Counties, and Towns. The delegate from Prince William, delegate Henson.

[00:36:32] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise today to introduce two groups with one introduction. So that supersedes. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would like to introduce the women of Zeta Phi Beta Sorority Incorporated and the men of Phi Beta Sigma Fraternity Incorporated, and I ask that they please stand.

[00:36:53] Mr. Speaker, as a member of the House, these are two historic organizations that were founded on the principles of scholarship, service, sisterhood, and brotherhood and are united by a shared commitment to social action and community uplift. Zeta Phi Beta Sorority Incorporated has long been a powerful voice in advancing education, public health, economic justice, and civic engagement across our communities. Phi Beta Sigma Fraternity Incorporated has constantly demonstrated leadership through advocacy, mentorship, and addressing the critical needs of those they serve. Together, these organizations

[00:37:30] exemplify what it means to turn service into action and advocacy and to meaningful impact. Mr. Speaker, we are especially honored today to acknowledge the triumphant Yvonne B. Miller in leadership and her dedication to public service and social justice to continue to inspire sorors and brothers and communities across the Commonwealth and beyond.

[00:37:52] Her legacy reflects the very purpose of advocacy today. We thank the Sigmas and we thank the Zetas for being present, for engaging in the legislative process, and for their continued commitment to building a stronger, safer, and more equitable communities. For that, Mr. Speaker asks that the House give them a warm house welcome.

[00:38:16] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate in the Bar. Mr. Speaker, I rise for the purpose of an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Today, I am honored to recognize Goochland Cares, an outstanding nonprofit serving families in Goochland County and the broader Richmond region.

[00:38:40] Will the members of Goochland Cares in the gallery please rise? For more than six decades, beginning with a small group of women in 1952 determined to help neighbors who fell through the cracks, Goochland Cares has grown into a trusted, community-centered resource grounded in compassion, dignity, and respect.

[00:38:58] Based in Goochland County, which Delegate Garrett and I share, it now offers a true one-stop shop of wraparound support, Medical and dental care, a food pantry, emergency housing assistance, domestic violence services, clothing and household goods, GED and ESL classes, tax preparation, and so much more.

[00:39:19] Each year, Goochland Care serves roughly 2,500 to 3,000 individuals, helping them meet basic needs and regain stability. Their vision is an equitable community where every person's basic needs are met and where individuals are empowered to live with self-dignity and well-being.

[00:39:37] Their doors never close, and they continue expanding their campus to meet growing needs. At a time when many families are struggling, even in a thriving region, Goochland Cares reminds us that real impact happens when neighbors step up for one another day in and day out.

[00:39:53] I want to thank their staff, volunteers, and supporters for their dedication and service. I hope my colleagues will give them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:40:11] Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery, we also have the Peninsula Agency on

Aging with us, and I ask that they please stand.

[00:40:28] For over 50 years, they have become the leading organization on fostering independence, dignity, and security for older adults in the communities of Newport News, Hampton, Pocosin, Williamsburg, York County, and James City County.

[00:40:47] They offer in-home personal care, information assistance, home-delivered meals, safety check-in calls, health and wellness sessions, caregiver support, and more to further their mission on empowering low-income seniors to age gracefully in their home of choice.

[00:41:07] We thank them for coming today, for their advocacy and their continued support, and I hope it will be the pleasure of the House to give them a warm welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Hampton, Delegate Ward.

[00:41:28] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, today we are joined by representatives of the oldest and the most important profession, not in Virginia, but in the world.

[00:41:47] They, Mr. Speaker, are midwives, student midwives, birth workers, and supporters from across the Commonwealth. I ask that they stand so they can be recognized. They are here to advocate for policies that support safe, accessible, equitable maternity care for Virginia's families.

[00:42:15] We thank them, Mr. Speaker, for their dedication to the health and well-being of parents, babies, and families across Virginia. And we welcome them to the Capitol today. Please give them a warm welcome.

[00:42:37] Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. So into House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on press and personal business and are going to leave from today's session. Delegates Converse Fowler, Delegate Knight. Clerk will announce the next order of business. Second portion of the morning hours, announcement of member request of legislation from any uncontested calendar block over to the regular.

[00:42:57] There are a number in the large, or was large, soon to be smaller, House Bill 2nd, uncontested. Page 17, House Bill 177 by Delegate Anthony. Page 18, House Bill 196, Delegate Thomas.

[00:43:15] House Bill, same page, House Bill 296, Delegate Siebold. Page 19, House Bill 682 by Delegate Zareb, House Bill 683 by Delegate Herring, and House Bill 799 by Torian. Over on page 20, House Bill 800 by Delegate Torian, House Bill 820 by Delegate Helmer, and House Bill 857 by Delegate Cousins.

[00:43:37] All of those are out of the block, over to the regular calendar. Over on page 21, also out of the block, is House Bill 882 by Delegate Sullivan. On page 22, House Bill 1053 by Delegate Phillips. On page 23, House Bill HB 1076 by Delegate Loffler.

[00:43:58] House Bill 1138 by Delegate Austin. House Bill 1221, as well as on page 24, House Bill 1227 by Delegate Thomas. All those are out of the block and over the regular calendar. So that's about 15 of those that will be moved over to regular calendar.

[00:44:18] Third portion of the morning hour, member requests for legislation go buy for the day. And as such, the motion to effectuate that. There are four such buy for the days that haven't been announced already. House Bill, on the first category, House Bill's third, uncontested, page 8, Delegate Wyatt's.

[00:44:37] House Bill 559, buy for the day at his request. On third, regular House Bill 1161 by Delegate Tran at her request. That legislation of hers, bye for the day. Over on page 32, in the category of second regular, Delegate McClure, House Bill 524, is bye for the day.

[00:45:02] And finally, that same category, but going forward to page 38, House Bill 1395, Delegate Converse Fowler. That legislation, piece of legislation, is bye for the day. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:45:25] Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation as announced by the clerk go by for the day. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation as announced by the clerk go by for the day. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will announce the next order. And, Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the fourth and final portion of the morning hour reserved for member requests for points of personal privilege.

[00:45:45] Kindly use your request to speak button to get into the queue. The delegate from Loudoun County, Delegate Reed. Mr. Speaker, I ask that we return to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us today in the gallery are emergency 911 dispatchers with the Association of Public Safety Communications Officials and the National Emergency Number Association. I'd ask if they could please stand. Mr. Speaker, emergency 911 dispatchers are the first of the first responders providing the essential first connection between those in need

[00:46:20] and emergency services. Every day, dispatchers manage life and death situations, experiencing many of the same psychological stresses and trauma as our frontline public safety professionals. Yet, unlike those in the field, they rarely receive closure as they move from one call to another without ever seeing the final outcome.

[00:46:39] Their service is vital to the safety and well-being of our communities, and their professionalism, composure, and dedication ensure that help arrives when it is most needed. Today, we are pleased to welcome these members as they join us for their annual and largest 9-1-1 to Richmond Day.

[00:46:55] Please join me in recognizing the critical service, and I hope it will be the will of the House to give them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:47:13] The delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Tater. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise today with a deep concern about proposed legislation that contradicts the promises made to voters in November.

[00:47:33] Virginians demanded affordability. They were promised affordability. Instead, now they're being handed a slate of bills that include more than 50 new tax increases and proposals. - Mr. Speaker, we cannot tax our way to affordability.

[00:47:50] Virginia has made national news for this legislative package and not in a good way. We are now on the cusp of having the highest income tax rate in the nation, a staggering 13.8% for some earners and small businesses.

[00:48:05] This is not affordable. There are a plethora of new daily use taxes that will strain the finances of every Virginian. Here's a quick sampling of what our citizens expect to pay. New local sales taxes. Delivery tax for on-demand services like Uber and Lyft which provide critical transportation services for

lower income individuals to get to and from work. Uber Eats, Amazon Delivery, UPS and FedEx. This will harm our homebound citizens including seniors and people with disabilities by preventing them from getting the items they need. Mr.

[00:48:43] Speaker this is not affordable. There are proposed taxes on gym membership and counseling services. We constantly talk about the mental health crisis. We want to encourage our citizens to access physical and mental health services and support without making them more costly. There are proposed taxes on dog walking and grooming. Just the other day I received a call from one of my constituents who provides dog walking services to supplement her retirement income. She now wonders if she will be able to continue in the wake of these new taxes and regulations.

[00:49:17] And how about car and home repairs? These expenses are often costly, unexpected, and not budgeted for. And now will take even more money out of Virginians' pockets. Mr. Speaker, this is not affordable.

[00:49:33] The new car tax and highway use fees, remember when everyone agreed to eliminate the car tax during the campaign? And yes, the investment income tax. This tax will disproportionately hurt seniors on a fixed income, again, not affordable.

[00:49:50] There's also a proposed event tax, concert ticket tax, and an increased hotel tax. These will be detrimental to Virginia's tourism industry, particularly in Virginia Beach. Virginia Beach is the largest city in the Commonwealth.

[00:50:07] There are six of us in this body who represent Virginia Beach. This will negatively impact all residents, all visitors, and all of us. And speaking of Virginia Beach, the storage facility tax will be largely felt by the military and veteran community who are constantly managing deployments in new duty stations.

[00:50:27] Mr. Speaker, this is not affordable. And Mr. Speaker, this isn't even an exhaustive list. There are proposed taxes on dry cleaning, guns and ammunition, barber shops, and digital streaming. year, I carried legislation to eliminate state taxes on tips, a measure that would have helped countless workers across the Commonwealth. That bill was killed by the other side of the aisle, and now, despite beginning this session with a $2.7 billion surplus, those same colleagues are creating an increasingly unaffordable environment for hardworking Virginians. Mr. Speaker, I hope

[00:51:05] you will urge my colleagues to rethink these burdensome tax increases that will hurt every single Virginian. We promised affordability. Now it's time to deliver. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Simons.

[00:51:30] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Many of my constituents are scientists employed at NASA Langley Research Center, including my husband, Paul. Over our almost 30 years of marriage, I've heard about many of his experiments in hypersonics, testing space vehicles, and wind tunnels, all very fascinating stuff. But last year, he started telling me about an experiment that was going to the moon. And I said, really? Tell me

[00:52:06] more. What I learned is that NASA is sending experiments to the moon as part of the Artemis mission for scientific discovery. They are using the data from these experiments to plan future moon landings and learn how to take heavier payloads to sustain a human presence on the moon.

[00:52:26] My husband is part of a team using several NASA-developed technologies, including one called SCALPS, or Stereo Cameras for Lunar Plume Surface Studies, to take video and images of the lander's plume as it touches down on the moon's surface. This experiment will measure how the plume of engine gases interacts with the moon's surface and kicks up lunar dust. And now, I am excited to share that NASA and the SCALPS team will be showing off their research tonight at the

[00:53:00] Aviation Aerospace and Advanced Air Mobility Legislative Reception. There will also be lots of out-of-this-world demonstrations from aerospace-focused businesses and universities providing our members the chance to learn about the latest in aeronautics, robotics, and drone technology. The reception includes barbecue dinner and will be held from 5 30 to 8 p.m.

[00:53:24] at the Main Street Station. Please join us for this event. It is always a blast. The delegate from Washington County, Delegate O'Quinn. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I request the return to the first morning hour for a brief introduction. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us today in the gallery, we have several folks visiting from ENCIRCLE, and I would ask that they please rise. ENCIRCLE, formerly known as Lutheran Family Services of

[00:54:02] Virginia, provides services to adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities, children in foster care, and students in special education across the Commonwealth of Virginia. Today, we have teachers, administrators, and staff from ENCIRCLE, including Minnick School, which is in Bristol, and they're visiting the Capitol to highlight the importance of specialized educational programs for children with complex educational and social needs. They serve students in 50 localities, a lot of those in Southwest Virginia, with a focus on evidence-informed instruction and successful transitions back to public school. So, Mr. Speaker, I'd ask that you

[00:54:37] join me in giving our guests a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we return to the first morning hour for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, today in the gallery, we have members of Empower RVA Teens. I would ask that they please rise. Empower RVA Teens is

[00:55:13] WICA Richmond's peer educator and leadership program for high school-aged youth in the Richmond region. The program aims to prevent teen dating violence and sexual assault by empowering teens to educate their peers about healthy relationships, red flags, and consent. In addition to their peer education work every year, empower RV 18s visit the General Assembly to meet with their representatives to discuss their legislative priorities, advocating for a world where everyone is free from violence, and taking the steps to build that world today. I request that the members

[00:55:48] please join me in extending them a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Runyon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I request return to the the first morning hour for purposes of an introduction.

[00:56:16] - Delegate has the floor. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Joining us in the gallery today, if they'll please rise, we have members of the Augusta County Board of Supervisors and County Administrator. I appreciate them coming to visit us with Richmond and see the process, thank you. Please join me in offering a warm house welcome to our friends from Augusta.

[00:56:38] - Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. - Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I ask that we return to the first morning hour for purposes of introduction. - Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Visiting us today is the Virginia Association of Defense Attorneys, and I'd ask them to please rise.

[00:56:57] The members of the association are here today meeting with members of the Courts Committee to share their perspective and expertise on legislation we're considering for this session. The Virginia Association of Defense Attorneys are engaging in civil defense and are committed to the professional and ethical representation of their clients upon Virginia courts.

[00:57:15] This evening, the association welcomes members to the House of Delegates to join them for their second annual session reception. It's going to be at the Credit Union House starting at 5 o'clock, and I hope that you will join us there. Please give them a warm House welcome. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:57:33] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The delegate from Stafford, Delegate Carroll. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, I rise because this month is Black History Month.

[00:57:52] And as I think about all of my experiences going through grade school, we talked a lot about what I consider to be trailblazing activists. But today, Mr. Speaker, I rise to give name for the behind-the-scenes warriors and trailblazers that laid the foundation in careers and spaces on the front line for the career that I now stand.

[00:58:18] Mr. Speaker, I learned a lot about Rosa Parks and her efforts and impact on civil rights. as a child in school but not Claudette Colvin. Colvin at the age of 15 was arrested nine months before Rosa Parks gained international fame for also refusing to give up her seat on the segregated bus. Mr. Speaker we celebrated the election of Barack Obama as the first black president of the U.S. but some in my generation don't know the impact of the peacemaker troublemaker groundbreaker an iconoclast of that none other than that Reverend Justin Jackson.

[00:58:59] Mr. Speaker, CPAs are often stereotyped to be quiet intellectuals that really love math. Mr. Speaker, I can tell you that it was the study of money and finance and how the integral understanding of it can change my life drastically that drew me into a study of accounting and finance.

[00:59:23] Mr. Speaker, CPAs are essential for ensuring financial integrity, providing high-level tax planning, and maintaining regulatory compliance for businesses and individuals. We act as trusted advisors, offering strategic financial analysis, auditing businesses, and providing risk management services to improve profitability to ensure long-term stability.

[00:59:47] Mr. Speaker, we help clients make sense of their financial data, which is crucial for informed decision-making that really stimulates economic growth. Mr. Speaker, did you know that 2 percent of this here House chamber are CPAs?

[01:00:09] Yes, 2 percent. My colleague, Delegate McNamara, and myself, yes. Mr. Speaker, I stand to give voice that, according to an AICPA report, only 2 percent of all CPAs in the U.S. are black. Today, here in Virginia, 5% of CPAs are black in relation to the national average. That 5% today has increased drastically since November of 1956, when Curtis Duke became the first black CPA here in the Commonwealth and won a fewer than 50 CPAs in

[01:00:47] the United States. Mr. Speaker, I give voice to Ruth Harris, the great-granddaughter of enslaved persons who grew up in Charlottesville during the Great Depression, and in 1962, hoping to motivate and inspire her students, she became the first black CPA here in Virginia.

[01:01:07] Mr. Speaker, by 1962, there were still fewer than 100 black CPAs in the nation, and fewer than five right here in the Commonwealth. Mr. Speaker, as we move forward, I relish the national average of 2 percent, and I relish the Commonwealth's average of 5 percent.

[01:01:30] I am reminded of the unspoken financial trailblazers who have made sense of the chaos and brings order to the data that impacts our daily lives today. Mr. Speaker, as a CPA, I stand, and we all benefit from their sacrifice and perspective to move forward when the only entrance to their future was through the back door.

[01:01:59] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Call a calendar.

[01:02:14] Calendar for today, Wednesday, February 4th, day 22 of our time together. Calendar for the Virginia House of Delegates. First category, House bills on third reading uncontested calendar. Final passage, uncontested. There are 32 pieces of legislation in the block, and they are as follows.

[01:02:32] House bill 148, 57, 94, 141, 184, 218, 304. Page 4, House Bill 316, 323, 327, 330, 346, 353. Over on page 6, continuing, third reading, uncontested calendar block, House Bill 395, 424, 437, 439, 479.

[01:02:55] Continuing over on page 8, House Bill 498 is in the block, House Bill 559 in the printed calendar is by today, therefore out of the block. Continuing with the block, House Bill 570, 586, 608, 628, page 10 of the printed calendar, House Bill 644, 788, 807, 809, as well as House Bill 828, 943, 1045, HB 1237.

[01:03:20] And rounding out third reading, final passage, third reading on contested counter block is House Bill 1308. Shall the bills pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:03:39] Ayes 97, noes 1. Ayes 97, noes 0. Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Scott County. Mr. Speaker. Delegate Kilgore, on the prevailing side, can we ask that we reconsider the block vote of the uncontested calendar so that a member may correct his vote?

[01:04:01] The Democrat from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore, having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed the uncontested block of bills, ask that we reopen the vote so that a member can vote on the uncontested docket. All those in favor, please say aye.

[01:04:18] Those opposed, no. That sounds like agreement. The motion is agreed to. Clerk will open the roll. Yes.

[01:04:33] The clerk will close the roll. Ms. Speaker, this time 98 to 0. Ayes 98, no 0. The bill's passed.

[01:04:50] Continuing with today's calendar, next category, new category, page 13, if you're following along that way, House bills on third reading, final passage, regular calendar, a dozen bills in this category, beginning with House Bill 423, relating to the Roanoke, Higher Education Authority, Board of Trustees, membership.

[01:05:08] Shall the bill pass? The clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, noes 0.

[01:05:26] Ayes 98, noes 0. The bill passes. House Bill 550 relates to admissions tax in counties, retail sales and use tax dedicated to promotion of tourism. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:05:48] Ayes 60, noes 37. Ayes 60, noes 37. The bill passes. House Bill 1071 would direct the Board of Education to develop alternative graduation pathways to earn a standard diploma report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:06:16] Ayes 87, noes 11. Ayes 87, noes 11. The bill passes. Over on page 14, we come to House Bill 422, legislation relating to water utilities, prohibition of multiple rate increases within three-year period for water utilities.

[01:06:32] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 69, noes 29. Ayes 69, noes 29. The bill passes.

[01:06:50] House Bill 440, now before you, relates to the Office of Vital Records, fees for certified copies. Shall the bill pass? House Bill 450, I apologize.

[01:07:09] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 466 relates to the State Corporation Commission time frame for completion of certain proceedings.

[01:07:26] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 77, noes 21. Ayes 77, noes 21. The bill passes.

[01:07:43] House Bill 633, top of page 15. This legislation relates to the Commission on Electric Utility Regulation. Name change. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, in having a chance to go back and look over this bill, I know that it seems like a simple name change, but I think we've all kind of gotten used to sewer.

[01:08:02] I know I don't like the way it sounds, but I do worry that there might be some confusion in changing this all of a sudden, at least an opportunity for some confusion. I don't know if we've made all the reference changes that needs to be made, so I'm going to be a no on this vote, Mr. Speaker. I hope that some of you all will as well. Thank you. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:08:30] Ayes 38, nos 58. Ais 38, nose 58, the bill fails. House Bill 791 relates to charitable gaming, conduct of athletic event drawings. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon.

[01:08:46] Mr. Speaker, speaking of the bill. Delegate on the floor. Mr. Speaker, this bill as well, we just had a big hearing about an iGaming bill in general law's gaming sub, and we had a lot of testimony about the dangers and addictiveness of gambling and so forth.

[01:09:01] And I'm, again, not sure that this bill is quite ready for prime time. And so, again, although I know it came through with not a lot of opposition before, I hope that some members will vote no on this bill today. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass?

[01:09:22] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 38, noes 58. Ayes 38, noes 58. The bill fails. House Bill 1052 relates to the Board of Pharmacy. Membership, registered pharmacy technician.

[01:09:38] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, this is one of these bills that's a lesson I've learned down here. We've got two CPAs in the body, but we only have one pharmacist. And the one pharmacist appears to have voted no on this pharmacy bill, and I think I want to trust his judgment on this. So I hope that the members will vote no on this bill today.

[01:09:56] Thank you. The delegate from Middlesex, Delegate Hodges. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Just to let the body know, I had changed my mind on this vote after reviewing it and talking to stakeholders.

Speaking to the bill. So I am a yes, Mr. Speaker.

[01:10:12] All right. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes 35, no 61.

[01:10:30] Ayes 35, no 61. The bill fails. Over on page 16, House Bill 1161 is by for the day. Therefore, next up, third reading, final passage, regular calendar. House Bill 606, now before you, relates to medical care facility data reporting value of charity care. Shall the bill pass?

[01:10:52] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 88, noes 10. Ayes 88, noes 10, the bill passes. House Bill 446 relates to the Virginia Passenger Rail Authority, eminent domain.

[01:11:10] Shall the bill pass? Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Mr. Speaker, I was reviewing this bill, and it seems to be moving down the track a little fast, so I would hope that we could put some no votes up on this bill.

[01:11:29] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:11:48] Ayes 73, noes 24. Ayes 73, noes 24. The bill passes. And House Bill 481 is legislation related to prior authorization requiring physician review for denial. Shall the bill pass?

[01:12:07] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The bill passes.

[01:12:23] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, rise for motion. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to pass, House Bills 633, House Bill 791, and House Bill 1052 on page 15 of the calendar. Can you repeat those bills? Yeah, House Bill 633, 791, and 1052 on page 15 of the calendar.

[01:12:41] I move that we reconsider that vote. Those votes? The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon, moves that we, having voted on the prevailing side by which we failed to pass House Bill 633, 791, and 1052, he moves that we reconsider that vote.

[01:12:57] All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Mr. Speaker? The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I move that House Bill 633, 791, and 1052 on page 15 of the calendar go by for the day. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon, moves that House Bill 633, 791, and 1052 go by for the day.

[01:13:14] So many in favor, the motion will say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The bills go by for today. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, continuing with today's calendar, new category, house bills on second reading, uncontested calendar.

[01:13:30] I believe there are six bills in that category at this point. The printed calendar, House Bill 177, out of the block to the regular calendar, page 18, House Bill 196, out of the block over to the regular calendar. House Bill 679 has been re-referred to CC&T.

[01:13:48] Over on page 19, House Bill 682, 683, and 799 out of this block over to the regular calendar. Over on page 20, House Bills 800, 820, 857 are out of the block over to the regular calendar. Therefore, the first bill in the reduced, uncontested, second reading block is top of page 21, Delegate Cousins, House Bill 861.

[01:14:12] House Bill 861 that seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to reporting requirements of state, regional, and local correctional facilities, pregnant and postpartum

inmates. Legislation report a committee on public safety with amendment nature of substitute. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins.

[01:14:28] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the adoption of the substitute. Shall substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Substitute is agreed to. Thank you. HB 861 asks Virginia's jails and prisons to include data related to pregnant and postpartum prisoners in their existing data reporting metrics. This bill will provide the Commonwealth with more information not only on the number of inmates who are pregnant or postpartum, but also on their health outcomes while incarcerated. This also requires that the data be shared with the Maternal Mortality Review Board and the chairs of the House and Senate committees for courts of justice. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and

[01:15:06] passed to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed to third reading. Well, this is uncontested. All right, my bad. I'm getting like Zara. My bad. Keep it moving. Mr. Speaker, continue with the uncontested block, House Page 21, House Bill 882, out of the block over to the regular counter. Therefore, in this bill, the next bill, second bill in the uncontested counter block is House Bill 887, legislation to amend and reenact portions of the Acts of Assembly of 1968, which provided a charter for the town of Herndon in Fairfax County, repeal, other sections, all relating to town manager, town employees, town attorney.

[01:15:41] Legislation report committee on county cities and town with an amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 887 amends and updates the charter for the town of Herndon at the request of their town council.

[01:16:00] It has to do with town manager residency requirements as well as updating the charter to make sure that it is in compliance with employment oversight. Thank you, Mr. Chair, or Mr. Speaker. I would move engrossment to the bill and move it, pass it to the third reading. Sorry, this is unfamiliar to me.

[01:16:15] Thank you. Turning to page 22, we come to House Bill 940. This is legislation amend and reenact portions of the Acts of Assembly of 1973 which provided a charter for the city of Suffolk relating to council composition, city clerk, department oversight.

[01:16:31] This legislative report committee on county, cities, and towns. Delegate from Suffolk, Delegate Clark. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 940 is a straightforward charter clean up bill for the city of Suffolk. First, it corrects the council composition language to reflect eight members consistent with the addition of a directly elected mayor back in 2008.

[01:16:48] Second, it removes obsolete city clerk language that referred to an initial appointment term that expired in 1970s and clarifies the clerk's roles as it exists in practice today. And then third, it updates the department's oversight provision to reflect the city manager's longstanding responsibility for department directors.

[01:17:06] This bill makes no policy changes and grants no new authority. It simply aligns the charter with the current operations to avoid confusion and improve clarity. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House,

engross the bill, and pass it on to his third reading. Continuing with the block, we come next, page 22, to House Bill 1039.

[01:17:25] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to the Department of Education. College and Career Ready Virginia program, administration, advisory committee, and work group composition. This is the legislation board committee on appropriations. Delegate from Richmond, Delegate Carr.

[01:17:41] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 103039 simply removes the Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond from the Career and College Ready Virginia Advisory Group. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, continuing the second reading on contested calendar block, bottom page 22, House Bill 1053 is out of the block over to the regular calendar.

[01:18:03] Similarly, on page 23, House Bills 1076, 1138, and 1221 out of the block over to the regular calendar. Therefore, over on page 24, House Bill 1227 is out of the block to the regular calendar. Therefore, continuing with the uncontested second reading block, we come to House Bill 1300, which is legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia related to the purchase of handguns or other weapons of certain officers.

[01:18:33] Department of State, please. Legislation reported on public safety. -Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. -Mr. Speaker, can that bill go to the regular calendar? -Without objection, HB 1300 goes to the regular calendar. -Thank you, Mr. Speaker. -Delegate from Grayson, Delegate Cornett.

[01:18:48] Oh, not now, go to the next. -And, Mr. Speaker, finally, the last bill in the uncontested secondary encounter block is House Bill 1342. This is legislation to amend and reenact sections There are portions thereof of the Acts of 1966 to provide a charter of the city of Fairfax relating to city elections powers.

[01:19:08] This legislation supports community on county, cities, and towns. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Bouliver. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate on the floor. Bill HB 1342 supports a charter change for the city of Fairfax. This bill does two things. First, it amends the city of Fairfax charter to align the November elections with the current law.

[01:19:28] Second, the City of Fairfax is seeking to set its own compensation amounts for boards and commissions and remove the $50 per meeting limit from the City Charter. Both amendments were requested in a resolution adopted by the City of Fairfax City Council. Mr. Speaker, I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading.

[01:19:49] Mr. Speaker. The delegate for Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yield for a question? Will the delegate yield? The delegate will yield. So, Mr. Speaker, I would ask the delegate how it is that she got all these Republicans to vote for this bill, a unanimous bill that seems to me to be a time machine bill, Mr. Speaker, because this bill goes back and resets the November, the May election to November as of 2022, here in 2026.

[01:20:21] And I can't get him to vote for anything of mine. I'm just wondering again how the delegate got all these Republicans to vote for this bill. Mr. Speaker, I would say to the esteemed delegate from Fairfax that in my vast three weeks of experience in this body, I have been overwhelmed with the spirit of bipartisanship, and I've been so welcomed.

[01:20:47] Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yield for an additional question? Will the delegate yield? The delegate will yield. Mr. Speaker, I'd ask the delegate, you know, since 2022, it seems like this is something your predecessor ought to have taken care of.

[01:21:03] and so do you have any idea why it is that your predecessor just didn't get around to doing this Mr. Speaker I feel I need to be very careful in answering this question I think I have had I have big shoes to fill with the prior delegate from Fairfax I think he did an amazing job and I think this came at the request from the Fairfax City Council and I am pleased to offer this to this body.

[01:21:44] That's all I would say. It was actually gifted to me by the prior delegate from Fairfax. Anyway, thank you. Mr. Speaker? Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Mr. Speaker, I was wondering if the patron would yield for a question.

[01:22:04] Would the delegate yield? The delegate carefully yields. I know the delegate hasn't been here that long, but I was wondering if she knew that we made hazing freshmen a felony in 2022. If Mr. Speaker, I would say to the delegate, if only that was true.

[01:22:30] Okay. Shall the bills be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bills are engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker, continuing with today's calendar, we've come to page 25, the printed version, following on that way.

[01:22:49] On IHOD, we come to a new category, House bills on second reading, regular calendar. House bills on second reading, regular calendar. About 48 bills in this new category.

[01:23:06] Beginning, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1377 legislation, there are floor amendments, but they are not available, so we might want to take that pass.

[01:23:33] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, so the floor amendments can be entered in the system, can this bill go by temporarily, please? Without objection, HB 1377 goes by temporarily. Therefore, Mr. Speaker, the first bill in this new category, we'll come pick that back up later, will be House Bill 649.

[01:23:54] House Bill 649 is legislation pitched by Delegate Hayes, which seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia-related removal of certain signs, advertisements placed within the limits of highways, agreements with local governing bodies, requirements, This legislation reported to the committee on transportation with an amendment of nature substitute.

[01:24:16] And, Mr. Speaker, the bill's patron has floor amendments to that substitute. Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Can this bill go by temporarily? Without objection, House Bill 649 goes by temporarily. Can you put that back together?

[01:24:35] Mr. Speaker, members of the House, therefore, we move down to House Bill 21, which is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia related to firearm industry members' standards of responsible conduct, civil liability. This legislation was put in the committee on public safety with an amendment in the nature of substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Hellman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:24:56] Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, this bill simply makes sure that gun manufacturers and dealers are treated under the same liability laws as every

other industry in Virginia. I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Liftwich. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:25:19] I would ask the rise to see if the patron would respond to a question. Would the delegate yield? Mr. Speaker, I yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would ask the delegate whether or not, in his opinion, this is effectively an end run around the Protection of Lawful Commerce and Arms Act.

[01:25:37] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Hillner. Mr. Speaker, on the contrary, I'd answer that this is a bill that operates within the framework of federal law, has been proven in other states, has been tested in court, and keeps our community safe. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the measure.

[01:25:53] The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill clearly impacts interstate commerce. It falls under the purview of the Commerce Clause, in particular Article I, Section 8, Clause 3 of the U.S. Constitution.

[01:26:09] And Congress has, in fact, enacted legislation regarding the substance of this bill by way of the Protection of Lawful Commerce in Arms Act. This bill unequivocally and ambiguously creates a purely subjective standard, which would subject interpretation to dozens, if not hundreds, of different interpretations across the Commonwealth.

[01:26:33] Mr. Speaker, without question, this bill violates the Commerce Clause and is an attempt to circumvent the protection of Lawful Commerce in Arms Act. Thank you. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:26:50] Continuing with second reading regular, we come to Page 26 in House Bill 34. This is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia related to the Virginia Military Forces Sexual Offense Prevention and Response Program established report.

[01:27:06] Legislation report building on public safety with an amendment. From Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 34 codifies the Sexual Offense Prevention and Response Program within the Department of Military Affairs to ensure members of the Virginia National Guard and Defense Force have access to independent victim advocacy.

[01:27:22] It places into statute the framework previously approved by this body, 93 to 3, last year, and I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Do the amendment. Oh, I'm sorry. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[01:27:45] All those opposed no. The committee amendment is agreed to? The pleasure of the body to engross and pass the bill to its third reading. Shall the bill be grossing past the third reading. All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill doesn't grossing past the third reading. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we come now to page 26, House Bill 40. House Bill 40 is legislation to amend and reenact Section Dakota, Virginia, related to manufacture, import, sale, transfer, or possession of plastic firearms and unfinished frames or receivers and un-serialized firearms prohibited penalties. Legislation report committee on public safety. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House,

[01:28:25] This is the ban on what we call ghost guns in Virginia. This bill is identical to the bill that passed this House the last two years and then was amended by the governor and then subsequently vetoed by the governor when we wouldn't agree to his amendments. This bill makes it illegal to import these unfinished frames. They're about 80% finished, and it doesn't take much to be able to complete that process and turn them into fully functional firearms.

[01:28:46] You can do that without a serial number, without a background check, without any of the safeguards we've built in to keep dangerous weapons out of the hands of people who shouldn't have them. I hope it's the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading all those in favor say aye all those opposed no the bills engrossed and passed the third reading over on page uh 27 we come to house bill uh 93 hospital 93 is legislation amended reenact uh two sections of the code of virginia relating to firearm transfers to another person from a prohibited person this legislation also reporting on public safety the delegate from alexander delegate bennett parker thank you mr speaker current law does not allow individuals convicted of domestic abuse to possess firearms House Bill 93 provides clarity for law enforcement and an enforcement mechanism

[01:29:26] to ensure that convicted domestic abusers do not have access to illegal guns. I move the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. Next up, House Bill 110. House Bill 110 is a legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to firearm in unattended motor vehicle civil penalty.

[01:29:52] This legislation reports on public safety with amendments. The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Lauffer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the House to adopt the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:30:08] The amendment just puts this fund into the Virginia Gun Violence Intervention Prevention Fund. Too many guns used in crime started as guns stolen from cars. HB 110 is a simple, common-sense step. If you leave a handgun unattended in your vehicle, it shouldn't be sitting out in plain view.

[01:30:26] This bill helps prevent theft and keeps our communities safer. HB 110 proposes a civil infraction and towing penalty for individuals who leave a firearm in an unattended vehicle that is visible to outside passers-by. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:30:42] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? The delegate from Fauquier County, Delegate Weber. Apologies, Mr. Speaker, I hit my button a little late. It's okay. Would the general lady yield for a question? Yes, I would. Would the delegate yield for a question? Yes, sorry. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, I yield.

[01:30:59] Delegate for fall care, Delegate Weber. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the delegate, since we are penalizing those law-abiding citizens that have a firearm and accidentally leave it where it can be seen, what is the penalty for the person who actually steals said firearm?

[01:31:18] Delegate, go ahead, Delegate. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would say to the gentleman that the person that steals would be the same as any crime that would be for a stolen gun. This is to prevent firearms coming into our communities from unattended vehicles.

[01:31:37] That's what this bill is about. I thank the delegate. Delegate, shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Turning to page 28, we continue second reading regular.

[01:31:54] House Bill 126 now before you is legislation to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to local, regional, and community correctional facilities access to counsel for inmates. Legislation again reported on public safety, this time with amendments. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson.

[01:32:10] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 126 directs the board of local and regional jails to establish clear standards for access to counsel and correctional facilities.

[01:32:26] Right now, an attorney's ability to meet with their clients varies from jail to jail or even day-to-day if it's available at all. Access to counsel is a constitutional right, and this bill directs our jails to provide clear policies so that right can be assured and reliable. I ask that it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading.

[01:32:45] Delegate from Bedford, Delegate Griffin. Mr. Speaker, will the gentlelady from Charlottesville yield for a question? But a delegate, you. Yes. A delegate, you. Mr. Speaker, does this provide greater constitutional rights to an attorney after conviction than prior to conviction?

[01:33:04] A delegate from Albemarle, a delegate of Carson. I would respond to the patron that this provides access to counsel regardless of where you are in the process. Sometimes people have been convicted or seeking appeals. The point is to make it so that your attorney can access you when you are in jail.

[01:33:21] Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. So we already know that if you are charged with a crime, you are given the right to an attorney. This bill appears to go beyond that after you're convicted, giving you constitutional rights to an attorney, not just day, but day and night, on weekends, essentially whenever you want.

[01:33:45] It gives greater access to an attorney for a convict than for any of us, any normal person in society. So it creates two classes of people. It creates the law-abiding that has no legal counsel and the criminal convicts who have legal counsel whenever they want.

[01:34:03] I think this is a bad bill. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up is House Bill 217. House Bill 217 is legislation to amend and reenact various portions of the Code of Virginia all relating to purchase, possession, sale, transfer, etc. of assault, firearms, and certain ammunition feeding devices prohibited penalties. Legislation report committee on public safety with an amendment nature of substitute.

[01:34:32] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Hillman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, two years ago, we introduced House Bill 2, which was a ban on assault weapons and heard from some on the other side of the aisle that this wasn't popular in Virginia.

[01:34:54] Overwhelmingly, Virginians responded that no. Weapons similar to those I carried in Iraq and Afghanistan have no place in our communities. Neither do the extended magazines that contribute to so much misery. This bill would ban the traffic and trade in those weapons and magazines, and I hope it is the will of this body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:35:13] The delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I was wondering if the delegate would yield for a question. Would a delegate yield? Mr. Speaker, I yield. The delegate will yield. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the delegate if a Virginian lawfully owns one of the grandfathered firearms that was grandfathered in before July 1 and wants to sell it, how would they go about doing that?

[01:35:43] Delegate for Fairfax, Delegate him. Mr. Speaker, I think the bill speaks clearly on that matter. This is a bill about keeping our communities safe, and as I said, I hope that given Virginians' overwhelming support, we can move this forward in a bipartisan manner. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, follow up. The delegate from Patrick, Delegate Williams.

[01:36:00] With a delegate yield. I'll yield for another question. I was wondering what exactly the law does say about when somebody can sell a grandfathered firearm. Delegate from Patrick, Delegate Helm. Mr. Speaker, the bill is clear on the transfer, sale, import, export of firearms and all of it, and I do encourage the delegate to read the full bill text.

[01:36:19] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, speak into the bill. Delegate on the floor. Mr. Speaker, I did read the bill, and we got a problem because, Mr. Speaker, even though the patron did not answer how you could actually sell or transfer one of these grandfathered weapons, the bill does say how you can do it.

[01:36:40] It says that you can sell it to a firearms dealer or you can sell it to an out-of-state individual. Did you know that it is a federal felony for someone from the Commonwealth to sell a firearm to someone who doesn't live in the Commonwealth?

[01:37:02] Did you know that? Selling also, that can bring up to five years in federal prison. So that's not a good idea. And then this bill right here, this actually makes it a state crime to sell a firearm to a firearm dealer.

[01:37:24] It says you cannot transfer it to any person, and there is no exception to allowing a dealer to purchase a firearm from you. The only exceptions that are in there is the dealer is able to sell to each other and to law enforcement.

[01:37:48] So the government can keep their guns, but you can't. But what about buybacks, Mr. Speaker? That's a good option. What about buybacks? That's allowed under this bill. It allows a locality to run them, but it makes somebody who wants to participate commit a misdemeanor.

[01:38:10] So that doesn't make sense. Oh, okay, we can do givebacks. We can do givebacks. No, can't do givebacks because then the organization putting on the giveback can't accept it because that's a misdemeanor.

[01:38:30] So what's left, Mr. Speaker? What is left? You can surrender it for nothing to the government, just like Australia. you can give it to a immediate family member, or you can die, and then your heirs can inherit it.

[01:38:52] That's it. That's the only way you'll be able to transfer a grandfathered rifle here in the Commonwealth without becoming a criminal. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate. The delegate from

Scott County, Delegate Kilgore.

[01:39:09] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speak to the bill. Delegate, that's the floor. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, I'm sorry to, you know, get up and talk, but I think we need to say a few things here. I'm, you know, being from rural Virginia, I'm not sure how this bill is going to be enforced.

[01:39:26] You know, we have a lot of constitutional officers out there, a lot of law enforcement officers who took an oath not only to abide by the Constitution of Virginia, but they also took an oath to abide by the United States Constitution, which is clear on Second Amendment rights.

[01:39:44] Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, I cannot, you know, there's no historical precedent for regulating firearms in this way, A magazine limit from the 1800s, I don't see anything like that. But I think that we can agree that the vast majority of these guns that we're talking about here today, AR-15s, are in common use for lawful purposes.

[01:40:09] Common use for lawful purposes. And the reason I'm saying that is this bill that we're passing today is going to run right into the buzzsaw of the Bruin case that was just decided. recently decided by the Supreme Court. Mr. Speaker, what we're gonna do as a Commonwealth, we're gonna spend a lot of money, our Attorney General's going to go up against the Justice Department, and we're gonna lose.

[01:40:35] We're gonna lose because this is clearly not the law, and it clearly violates the Second Amendment. So, Mr. Speaker, I would urge caution when going forward on bills such as this that clearly are violative of the Constitution of the United States.

[01:40:52] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. So the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading. All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 226 is the legislation amend the Code of Virginia relating to County Manager Plan of Government Independent Policy Auditor.

[01:41:11] This legislation is worth committing on county cities and towns. Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, members of the body, House Bill 226 amends the County Manager Plan of Government to allow local governing boards to hire an independent police auditor. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to his third read.

[01:41:29] The delegate from Bedford County, Delegate Griffin. Mr. Speaker, speaking of the bill. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, this is, so already in Virginia Code, we have this appointed board that has to have its diversity. That's already in the law.

[01:41:44] And so what this bill does is this adds a roving anti-police auditor investigator to go around and investigate the police. So he's not elected, and then he's appointed by, you guessed it, a board that's not elected.

[01:42:01] So now we have a bunch of bureaucrats running around investigating the police with no oversight. Now, you know that if you have a city, you have a city council, and they have a city manager, and the city manager in consultation with the city council will hire their police chief.

[01:42:18] In the counties where we live, you have constitutional officers, you have sheriffs that are elected. So you have law enforcement that actually reports to the people. This is just a left-wing officer from, really, the code reads like it has to be a left-leaning board, and they appoint a police auditor to just run around and investigate police at the urging of the board.

[01:42:42] I think this is a very bad idea. I think it's another Democrat pro-crime bill, and I urge my colleagues to vote no. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed in past the third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[01:42:57] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed in past the third reading. House Bill 229 now before you is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to weapons. Possession prohibited in a hospital that provides mental health services or developmental services penalty. Legislation report committee on public safety with amendment nature substitute.

[01:43:14] Delegate from Norfolk, Delegate Hernandez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This legislation is designed to protect our frontline health care workers. This bill would make it unlawful to knowingly possess a weapon, as it's defined in the bill, in hospitals. And it would impose a class one misdemeanor for violations. We have once again worked to structure this legislation in a way that is narrowly tailored to the problem.

[01:43:45] This legislation reads very similar to language in current code that keeps weapons out of both schools and courtrooms. So I move that we engross the bill and pass it along to his third reading. The delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. A question for the patron, Mr. Speaker. Would the delegate yield? I yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would ask the gentlemen, if law enforcement officers who are going to the hospital, maybe to question someone, to question a victim or someone that they need to talk to, would they be able to transport their firearm into the hospital?

[01:44:18] Mr. Speaker, I would respond to the delegate that there is currently, as this is written right now, an exception for on-duty law enforcement. We, in the last 24 hours, I've had conversations with state police and sheriffs to address some of their additional ideas about how we can respond to the delegates' points.

[01:44:35] So this bill is likely to get even better and better, but the underlying point is to protect our frontline health care workers. And final question, Mr. Speaker? The delegate has the floor. I read that, and I couldn't make a determination, and I probably had my question wrong the first time.

[01:44:51] What about off-duty police officers? Would they be off-duty when they're visiting a family member or a friend? Mr. Speaker, I would respond to the delegate that the bill, as written, includes on-duty law enforcement. What we have been working with law enforcement now is to get the language right for off-duty.

[01:45:10] So those conversations are continuing. And like I said, the bill is going to get better and better as we move forward. I thank the gentleman. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. From page 30, we come to second reading, regular House Bill 277.

[01:45:31] This legislation seeks to amend—no, did I skip it? I'm eager. All right, mea culpa. House Bill 257.

[01:45:47] House Bill 257 seeks to amend and reenact sections of the code of Virginia related to comprehensive plans, social determinants of health. Legislation report committee on county, cities and towns. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Simons. Thank you Mr. Speaker. HB 257 is a permissive bill which allows localities to use existing health data as part of its next and any subsequent review of the

comprehensive plan. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading. All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Now we come Welcome to House Bill 277, this is legislation to amend and re-enact sections code of Virginia related to zoning,

[01:46:26] wireless communications infrastructure, application process, legislation reporting on county, city, town's amendment, nature, substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sebo. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:46:42] Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 277 expands coverage and increases wireless reliability in the Commonwealth. creating a clear, uniform process for reviewing modifications and upgrades to wireless infrastructure. I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:47:01] Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 286 now before you. Seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia, all relating to the Virginia National Guard, power of the governor to summon, in certain circumstances, mobilization under federal authority.

[01:47:18] Annual Report, Legislation Report, Committee on Public Safety. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill simply puts guardrails to make sure we ensure that federal deployments and mobilizations in the National Guard are legal.

[01:47:34] I hope it is will this body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Delegate from Rockingham, Delegate Will. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, I had a series of questions to ask the delegate, But I'm going to forego those because he, along with a lot of the rest of us, were present in the committee meeting when we heard testimony from the Department of Military Affairs.

[01:48:03] Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, we need to take a pause here. Because I think if we really look deeply at the intent, this is an attempt to kind of play a cat and mouse game with the federal government. Because we don't like certain actions that we're seeing from there.

[01:48:23] So we're going to put our Virginia National Guard as a pawn between us and the federal government. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, the bill risks doing profound and lasting harm to the women and men in our Virginia National Guard.

[01:48:41] That's who the Guard is, and that's who's at stake here. Testimony in the committee from the Department of Military Affairs made it clear that if enacted, this legislation could place Virginia in violation of federal cooperative agreements governing the joint state federal use of armories and other facilities.

[01:49:01] As a result, the federal government would be within its right to withdraw funding, 96 percent of the Guard funding, as well as approximately 80 percent of the Department of Military Affairs staffing. To speak to the ladies and gentlemen of the House, we're talking about around $450 million annually.

[01:49:24] I won't ask the chair of appropriations to stand, but I'm guessing that he probably doesn't have $450 million available yearly to put into the funding of the Virginia National Guard if it were taken away by

the federal government.

[01:49:42] The practical effect of this bill would be to place the readiness of our National Guard, our emergency response capabilities, and the well-being of our guardsmen at serious risk. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, I'm going to ask, are we willing to take that gamble?

[01:50:03] Are you willing to take that gamble? We need to draw ourselves back here, consider what really is at stake. I urge the body to vote no on this legislation. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:50:21] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 325 now before you. This legislation is amended and reenacted the Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Fire programs' mental health awareness training. This legislation is reported to the Committee on Public Safety, and then it was subsequently reported favorably as well by the Committee on Appropriations.

[01:50:41] Doug from FireFast, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 325, Mr. Speaker, directs the Department of Fire programs to create a training program for mental health awareness that satisfies the criteria already in current law requiring each fire department to develop curricula for mental health awareness training for its personnel.

[01:50:58] I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House bill 388 now before you is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact sections of the code of Virginia relating to powers of service districts' control of invasive plants.

[01:51:18] Legislation report going on counties, cities, and towns with an amendment. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 388 adds the control of invasive plants, as established by the Department of Conservation and Recreation, to the list of service district powers.

[01:51:40] I ask that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Turning to page 32, House Bill 524, and the printed calendar is by for the day. Therefore, the next bill before you, second reading regular, is House Bill 553.

[01:51:56] Legislation Amendment Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Corrections, Language Services for Offenders. Legislation report, Benny, on public safety with amendments. Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to?

[01:52:11] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendments are agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The purpose of HB 553 is to codify already existing Department of Corrections' gold standard court-approved policies guaranteeing translation services to non-English speakers behind bars every incarcerated individual whether seeking rehabilitative rehabilitative care attending disciplinary hearings or obtaining medical treatment deserves the right to access translation services in their native

language this bill will improve the safety of both officers and incarcerated individuals while ensuring the doc policies are meaningfully enforced with that mr speaker i move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading

[01:52:49] delegate from betford delegate griffin mr speaker will the delegate yield for a question Yes, I will yield. Mr. Speaker, isn't it true that an English speaker can be punished for not following orders in jail, but this bill says that if you don't speak English, you are no longer punished for not following directions in jail?

[01:53:09] Delegate from James City County. Mr. Speaker, this is actually just creating a fair system with the Department of Corrections to ensure that every individual that is incarcerated is going to know what actions are being demanded of them, if they are in trouble, if they are dealing with disciplinary.

[01:53:25] This is simply giving fair treatment across all incarcerated individuals. Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Bedford, Delegate Griffin. Mr. Speaker, speaking of the bill. Delegate on the floor. Mr. Speaker, false, actually. Actually, what the bill says, so it's one of those bills that masquerades as an English learning bill.

[01:53:45] And so I would be in favor of an English learning bill. But you'll find in reading the bill that 90 percent of the bill is making accommodations for non-English speakers in jail. And it is true that, and it says this in the bill, if you're an English-speaking person and you don't follow directions in jail, you can be disciplined.

[01:54:05] That's the word that's used in the bill, disciplined. But if you're a non-English speaker and it's communicated to you in English that you must follow certain rules and you don't follow the rules, then you get a pass. Once again, it creates two classes of citizens in jail.

[01:54:21] If you're an English speaker, you are at a disadvantage. If you're a foreign language speaker, you are all of a sudden playing by a different set of rules. The bill is full of accommodations for foreign language speakers. The jail has to print them off a card saying what language they speak.

[01:54:39] There's 13 documents that are required to be printed for the convict, the non-English speaking convict, and a different language. We have to provide an interpreter every 48 hours for this person. We need to be prioritizing not only the lawful, I know that's like a controversial statement in here, the lawful over the unlawful, but more importantly on this bill, we need to be prioritizing English-speaking people over non-English-speaking people.

[01:55:06] These accommodations, I think, are way out there. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Should a bill be engrossed to pass the third reading? Are those in favor, say aye. Are those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed to pass the third reading. Continuing with the calendar, we move to page 33, House Bill 626.

[01:55:25] This is legislation to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia related to carrying a firearm or explosive material within Capitol Square or building owned or leased by the Commonwealth. Exemptions. Public institution of higher education penalty. Legislation report really on public safety. Delicate from Albemarle. Delicate Carson.

[01:55:41] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 626 would make it a class one misdemeanor to carry firearms on our public college campuses. As a reminder, guns are currently not allowed on our college campuses, but it's an administrative rule, and this allows for police intervention when needed. It does

have an exception for university-sanctioned programs and curriculum, and as many in this House may remember, we have passed similar legislation twice.

[01:56:04] I would ask that it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 7 and 11 now before you as a legislation to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia to land a local regulation of solar facilities, special exceptions.

[01:56:23] The legislation was reported on county cities and towns with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill amends the Virginia Code to allow owners of agricultural, industrial, and institutional land to apply for special exceptions to install ground-mounted solar facilities.

[01:56:47] The bill requires that any special exception would have to meet certain environmental, community benefit, and workforce requirements. Importantly, the bill keeps local control over the final decision of any new solar energy project.

[01:57:04] Unless the locality has a by-right process, no project would be allowed to move forward without a vote from the locality's board of supervisors. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:57:22] Next up, House Bill 802 is legislation to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to vacant building registration, registered agents. Legislation report committee on county, cities, and towns. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:57:38] HB 802 gives localities the authority to, by ordinance, require owner or agent contact information for vacant buildings. This simply assists localities in their efforts to manage urban blight. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:57:55] Should a bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing with second reading, regular calendar, page 34, House Bill 806. Now before you, legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to Industrial Development Authority's housing.

[01:58:11] Legislation reporting for many counties, cities, and towns. Delegate for Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 806 follows up on my 2022 legislation, which gave economic development authorities the ability to issue grants for affordable housing.

[01:58:27] This legislation gives them bonding authority to continue their great work in producing more housing units. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:58:42] House Bill 867 is legislation to amend and re-enact section of the Code of Virginia related to affordable housing. Local Zoning Ordinance Authority, Legislation Report Committee on Counties, Cities,

and Towns with amendments. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move adoption of the committee amendments.

[01:59:00] Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to. Delegate from Richmond. Thank you. HB 867 grants all localities in the Commonwealth the ability to establish inclusionary zoning programs tailored to the needs of their communities.

[01:59:18] Currently, only a handful of localities in Virginia are authorized to implement these programs. This bill simply extends the authority to all localities in the Commonwealth, giving them the option to implement inclusionary zoning programs if they so choose. The bill also requires localities to gather robust community feedback when designing these programs.

[01:59:37] As amended in committee, the bill requires reenactment by the 2027 General Assembly Session and also includes a delayed enactment clause. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:59:54] Over on page 35, we come to House Bill 871, legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to storage of firearms in a residence where a minor or person prohibited from possessing a firearm is present. Penalty. Legislation to support a committee on public safety. Delegate from York County, Delegate Downey.

[02:00:11] Mr. Speaker, I'm proud to present House Bill 871, the Safe Storage and Homes Act. This bill requires that in residences where a minor or a person prohibited from possessing a firearm is present, that the owner of the firearm must secure it by either storing it unloaded in a safe, with ammunition being stored separately in a safe, or if loaded, stored in a biometric safe.

[02:00:32] Mr. Speaker, I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading. The delegate from Campbell County, Delegate Zare. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise to a question for the patron. Will the delegate yield for a question? I yield. Delegate yield. Mr. Speaker, if my 16-year-old daughter, who happens to be a champion marksman with years of firearm training, uses a firearm in my home to defend herself from an attacker, am I guilty under this bill?

[02:01:01] Mr. Speaker, yes, the definition of minor is what's in the current code, 17 and under. Follow-up question, Mr. Speaker. Delegate has the floor. Is there any explicit exemption in the bill for emergency or defensive access by a minor, or would that be left entirely to prosecutorial discretion?

[02:01:25] Mr. Speaker, I would answer the— Can the Delegate give us an additional question? Yes? I yield. Okay, go ahead. He does. Go speak. Delegate Downey? Yes. Ms. Spear, I would say to the Delegate, as a pediatrician, I know firsthand the horrific consequences of kids obtaining firearms as a leading cause of death for America's children and young adults.

[02:01:46] The significant majority of the guns used in school shootings and teen suicides by firearm were obtained from the home or relative or friend. These deaths are preventable, and HB 871 is a critical step towards saving lives. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[02:02:03] Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Yes, Mr. Speaker. Speaker, question for the patron. Would the delegate yield for an additional question? I yield. Delegate yield. I just hear that line a

lot. It says, like, I think you said the firearms are the number one killers of children in the U.S. or America or what else.

[02:02:22] Is that accurate? Is that what you're saying? Mr. Speaker, answering the delegate, this bill simply prevents unnecessary deaths. And, yes, it's been documented as the number one killer of children in this country. All right. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[02:02:39] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shen. Were you speaking to this bill? Oh, that's okay. We're in the middle of a debate. You're hitting buttons. Okay. Chair, the bill will be engrossed and passed the third reading. All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[02:02:55] Next up is Delegate Shins, House Bill 876, legislation to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia related to zoning, wireless facilities, temporary support structure, legislation to get and report a committee on county, cities, and towns. Delegate for five minutes, Delegate Shins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I was not trying to get involved in that mess happening over there.

[02:03:12] House Bill 876 will ensure that all localities have a process for telecommunication companies to deploy temporary towers to ensure wireless customers can stay connected during large-scale events or emergency situations. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[02:03:28] Should the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. House Bill 888 is legislation to amend and reenact sex to the Code of Virginia, this time relating to minimum off-street parking requirements in certain areas. This legislation is reporting video on county, cities, and towns with the amendment of nature to substitute.

[02:03:46] Delegate for Fairfax, Delegate Sheehan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 888 helps to address the supply side of our housing affordability crisis by setting reasonable limits on minimum parking requirements in designated areas where those residents might already have access to public transit or mass transit alternatives.

[02:04:10] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and move to its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 36, we come to a new bill, same patron, House Bill 891. This one seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia relating to siting of battery energy storage projects, commercial solar photovoltaic generation facilities permitted accessory use.

[02:04:35] Legislation, again, reporting committee on county, cities, and towns. Senator Farfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 891 proposes to include battery energy storage on solar sites with already approved conditional use permits. It continues to preserve existing financial and community benefit terms while maintaining public safety and compliance requirements to the highest standards.

[02:04:56] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's

engrossed and passed to third reading. House Bill 1011 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to compost and other products containing organic soil amendments infrastructure.

[02:05:14] Department of Environmental Quality tax policy options for reforming the litter tax study expanded. Civil penalty. Legislation report committee on county, cities, and towns with an amendment. That is from Fairfax. Delegate Tran. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House adopt the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[02:05:30] Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, this bill is permissive, allowing localities to establish ordinances for food diversion or composting strategies for certain facilities. It also directs the Department of Environmental Quality to examine ways to expand composting, anaerobic digestion, and other strategies statewide.

[02:05:49] I move that the House engross this bill and pass it along to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1130 is legislation to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to workforce housing for employees of locality or school board lease of surplus property.

[02:06:09] Legislation, again, reporting on county cities and town. From Loughton County, Delegate Reed. Yes, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1130 allows local school boards to contract with housing authorities, nonprofits, or private developers to be able to build workforce affordable housing for school system employees who earn 120% of the average median income or less.

[02:06:30] And I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the legislation and move it on to its third reading. The delegate from Bedford, Delegate Griffin. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, last week we talked about this exact same code section, and the debate last week was whether we should give free housing, like give it away, like give grant money, cash, to government workers to buy homes.

[02:06:50] And I said, we said that taxpayer money was not to be redistributed to government workers to buy their own homes, especially when 30% of Americans can't afford to buy their own home. The Democrats responded that, no, that is what they want to do, is they're going to take our taxpayer money and they're going to buy their friends in government homes.

[02:07:09] This is the exact same bill. Excuse me. This is the exact same law that they're amending, but this is deeper into, you know, 15.2, 958.2. What this bill does is it doesn't give them free homes to own, grant money to buy homes.

[02:07:25] This one gives them free, reduced rental homes. So Democrats are giving their friends, government workers, reduced rental places to live. Government is not here to give your friends financial favors.

[02:07:41] Taxpayers do not deserve to have their tax dollars taken from them so that you can redistribute it to your friends. I disagreed when it was a grant to give them homes. I disagree when you're giving them reduced prices on rental homes. That's not what government is for. I oppose this bill, Mr. Speaker.

[02:08:00] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up is House Bill 1144, Legislation

Amendment and Reenact, Section Dakota, Virginia, relating to water and sewer connection fees, first-time homebuyers, affordable housing.

[02:08:15] This legislation, reporting committee on county, cities, and towns with amendments. Delegate from Lotton County, Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that the House adopt the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to all those in favor say aye. All those opposed no, the committee amendment is agreed to.

[02:08:31] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1144 provides that any locality may provide for the full or partial reimbursement to a first-time homebuyer of water and sewer connection fees, capital recovery charges, and availability fees paid in connection with any new residential development conveyed to such homebuyer.

[02:08:53] The bill permits any locality that has adopted an affordable housing dwelling unit ordinance to provide for a waiver of such fees and charges. Simply put, the permissive bill gives each locality a tool to lower the cost of housing for first-time homebuyers.

[02:09:11] And I also believe the esteemed delegate will appreciate the brevity of my presentation. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. You know that wasn't true. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading.

[02:09:31] Up to page 38, we come to House Bill 1279. HB 1279, Legislation Amendment reenacts sections of the Code of Virginia related to affordable housing, religious organizations, and other non-profit tax-exempt properties. Legislation worth the busy committee on county, cities, and towns with amendments.

[02:09:48] Delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the committee amendments. Shall the committee member be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee members agree to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1279 lets faith groups use their land to build homes. It removes barriers and red tape, and it gives communities more tools to help their neighbors.

[02:10:06] It also includes a reenactment clause, which means the law will not go into effect unless we come back again next year and pass it. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross and pass the bill on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. House Bill 1395 is by for the day, therefore top of page 39, we come to House Bill 1404.

[02:10:28] This legislation seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to local governing bodies, appointment of youth representative, legislation reporting on counties, cities and towns. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Guzman. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1404 would grant local governing bodies the authority to appoint a non-voting student representative.

[02:10:46] This is a great way to involve youth in the legislative process. When young people feel their voices are heard, they are more likely to be engaged citizens. Local school boards in the Commonwealth that have adopted procedures to appoint student representatives have seen youth civic engagement increase during school board meetings.

[02:11:05] Mr. Speaker, I ask members of this body to engross this bill and pass it into its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Now, Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we come to about a dozen and a half bills that have been moved around.

[02:11:23] So we'll go back on the calendar if you're following that way. Page 17, House Bill 177, now before you. This is legislation to amend and reenact section of the code of Virginia laying the fee for passing bad checks to localities. Payment order not paid by a recipient. Legislation for it being on counties, cities, and towns with amendments.

[02:11:39] Delicate from Norfolk, Delicate Anthony. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to all those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. The Senate has the floor. House Bill 177 focuses on non-payment, not human error, and modernizes the statute for non-paper payments in collaboration with the Treasurer's Association of Virginia.

[02:12:02] And I hope it would be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to the third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Going ahead to page 18, we come to House Bill 196, Legislation Amendment, Dakota, Virginia, Land, and Virginia Residential Development Infrastructure Fund established.

[02:12:21] Legislation report committing on appropriations with Amendment Nature Substitute. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Chairman Speaker, House Bill 196 establishes the Virginia Residential Development Infrastructure Pilot Program, which essentially allows the Commonwealth to assist localities when they are trying to get a new development project put in and there's an infrastructure issue causing a hiccup.

[02:12:47] It would allow the Commonwealth to step in under DHCD and provide financing for that project, creating more affordable housing throughout the Commonwealth. I hope it is the will of the chamber to engross the bill and pass on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading.

[02:13:02] Next up is House Bill 296, which seeks to amend and reenact. Let's go to Virginia, Orlando State Correctional Facilities Visitation Policies Report. Legislation was reported on public safety. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sebald. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill.

[02:13:18] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 296 requires the Department of Corrections to establish and post an objective dress code for visitors, ensuring that no visitor is denied entry unless they are in clear violation of visitation policies. Hope is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to his third reading.

[02:14:02] ACLU is on there, in code, as like somebody who's getting an opinion on certain prison policies. We've got a group in there that has, that when you go on their website, they're lambasting our

former Attorney General, the Honorable Jason Meares. We've got a number of these groups that are bragging about all the murderers that they helped set free from prison.

[02:14:25] This is like the work group. It's a bunch of left-wing groups. Where is the voice for the victims? This is another one that puts pro-crime groups before pro-victim groups, and I have to vote against this. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[02:14:42] The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing second reading, regular calendar. We come now to House Bill 682, legislation to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia related to the Fire Programs Fund, aid to localities, redistribution of funds.

[02:14:57] This legislation report committee on appropriation. Delegate from Campbell County, Delegate Zare. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill provides that funds forfeited by the locality through the Aid to Localities program could be used by the Virginia Fire Services Board for other targeted grants to address needs in the fire service.

[02:15:13] I hope it's the will of the body to engross and pass this to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 683 now before you seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Relating to Solar Interconnection Grant Program established.

[02:15:30] Report sunset, this Legislation Reporting Committee on Appropriation. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill, the Solar Interconnection Grant Program, awards grants on a competitive basis to public bodies to offset the costs that they will experience to connect to the grid with their solar facilities.

[02:15:49] A lot of our public schools are facing issues right now, and this grant will provide them assistance. Priority is given to solar facilities located in previously developed sites. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye.

[02:16:05] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 799 is next up. It seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to Power Transformer Manufacturing Grant Fund. This legislation is reported on appropriation. That's from Prince William, Delegatory. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 799 codifies the MEI Commission-approved economic development project for Hitachi to build large power transformer in Fairfax County.

[02:16:30] The company will create 825 jobs and invest $457 million in Fairfax County. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to this third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[02:16:46] New bill, same patron. This bill before you next is House Bill 800. This is legislation in Minnesota, Virginia, relating to the active pharmaceutical ingredient manufacturing grant fund. Again, this is Legislation Report Committee on Appropriations. That is for President Williams, Delegatory. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[02:17:01] Mr. Speaker, House Bill 800 codifies the MEI Commission-approved economic development project for Eli Lilly to produce active pharmaceutical ingredients in Goochland County. The company will create 468 jobs and invest $2.1 billion in Goochland County.

[02:17:17] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed in third reading. Next up is House Bill 820, legislation to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia, related to Virginia, Housing Trust Fund, Mixed Income Development.

[02:17:34] Legislation was reported for the Committee on Appropriations with the Amendment of Nature Substitute. Douglas from Fairfax, Douglas Hale. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this is an administration bill that creates a Virginia House. Substitute. Move the committee substitute, Mr. Speaker. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to?

[02:17:50] All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, with the committee's substitute, this is an administration bill that creates a Virginia Housing Revolving Loan Fund so we can build more housing so people can afford to live in their housing. I hope it is will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[02:18:09] The bill will be engrossed and passed the third reading. Are those in favor to say aye? Are those opposed, no? The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing with second reading, regular House Bill 857. Now before you is legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia, all relating to a home electronic incarceration program.

[02:18:27] Letters say supporting committee on public safety with an amendment nature substitute. Doug from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitutes agree to. Thank you. HB 857 creates a statutory presumption, not a requirement, that pregnant, postpartum, and nursing women in Virginia's jails be placed on home electronic incarceration when possible.

[02:18:52] This will help to ensure improved health outcomes and time for mother-child bonding. Importantly, this presumption is rebuttable if authorities determine that the woman is a threat to herself, a threat to others, or if she poses a flight risk.

[02:19:07] This bill also clarifies that after the postpartum period, currently defined in the code to be eight weeks, expires, these women can be granted permission to remain on home electronic incarceration. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[02:19:24] Should the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The building goes to pass the third reading. Continuing with the calendar, we've come now to House Bill 882. Legislation to amend and reenact Section of Dakota, Virginia, related to the Innovative Internship Fund and Program, Local Government Employers and Matching Funds, Legislative Support Committee on Appropriations.

[02:19:46] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB882 ensures that local governments are eligible to benefit from Virginia's Innovative Internship Fund, which helps grow internship opportunities throughout the Commonwealth. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[02:20:02] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up is House Bill 1053. House Bill 153 seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Acts of Assembly of 2020, 2021, 2022, and 2023, all relating to Go! Virginia grants matching funds.

[02:20:22] This legislation reports committee on appropriations. Delegate from Henry County, Delegate Phillips. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This bill simply reenacts what had been law previously that allows you to take Tobacco Commission funds and use them as GoVirginia funds and use them as matching funds for Tobacco Commission grants.

[02:20:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Want it engrossed? Hit your button. Say it for everybody. Say it with your chest. And I move that we engross this bill. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. And pass it on to his third reading. And pass it on to his third reading. There you go. We got you shook up today, man.

[02:20:55] Should a bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing with second reading regular, we come now to House Bill 1076, Legislation Amendment Code of Virginia relating to Pharmaceutical Substance Manufacturing Grant Fund. Legislation was working on appropriation.

[02:21:12] Delicate from Albemarle, Delegate Laufer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1076 codifies a custom performance grant initiative package approved by the MEI commission. The project represents a capital investment in at least 600 new jobs in the Albemarle County area.

[02:21:29] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. Next up, House Bill 1138. This is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact two portions of the Code of Virginia relating to economic development incentives, wage requirements, legislation, again, reported for putting on appropriations.

[02:21:50] Delegate from Boniton, Delegate Austin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I have House Bill 1143. Is that not correct? Is it 1138? Okay, Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1138 is based upon recommendations from JLARC and update wage requirements for the Virginia Job Investment Act, VIP, and the Virginia Investment Performance Grant.

[02:22:22] It ties both programs to the prevailing wage as defined by the code in the locality where the project is located. It also allows the project in both single and double-distressed localities to qualify at 85% prevailing average wage, consistent with other major discretionary incentives in Virginia.

[02:22:39] I move that the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1221 is now before you. It seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to public institutions of higher education, financial aid review and consolidation Virginia Guaranteed Assistance Program and Fund Virginia Commonwealth Award established work group report. All this legislation was all approved by the reporter for the committee on appropriations. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sue.

[02:23:11] Thank you Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1221 establishes the Virginia Commonwealth Award consolidating current programs clarifying definitions and provisions for eligibility and renewal for

grad and undergraduate students. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading. Should a bill be engrossed and passed its third reading?

[02:23:28] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Bill is engrossed and passed its third reading. Next up, House Bill 1227, legislation to amend and reenact. Actions go to Virginia relating to private activity bonds allocation of state sealing. Legislation again, report a committee on appropriations. Delegate from, oh, I'm sorry. Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Thomas.

[02:23:46] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1227 reallocates our private activity bonds allocation, 10% from industrial, putting 3% through DHCD for local government, 7% for Virginia housing, all to create more affordable housing in the Commonwealth. I hope it's the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading?

[02:24:03] All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Ms. Speaker, now we come to House Bill 1300. House Bill 1300 seeks to amend and reenact sections of Virginia later under purchase of handguns or other weapons of certain officers, Department of State Police.

[02:24:20] This legislation reporting committee on public safety. Delegate from Grayson County, Delegate Cornett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1300 authorizes the Department of State Police with approval from the superintendent to allow the immediate survivor of a law enforcement officer who served at least 10 years with the department and died while receiving long-term disability payments to purchase the officer's service weapon for $1.

[02:24:41] I ask that the body engross the bill and pass it to the third reading. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, can this bill go by for the day? Oh, I'm sorry. Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yell for a question? Mr. Speaker, after Delegate Williams' comments, I will yield.

[02:25:05] Delegate will yield. The Delegate will yield. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the Delegate something. I'm sure I'll think of something. Where did the idea for this bill come from? Mr. Speaker responded to the Delegate.

[02:25:21] It came from my district, and actually an officer that passed away, that was a state trooper, and this situation applies directly to him. Mr. Speaker, that's why I didn't think there was much funny about this bill. So I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to, oh, I thank the delegate for the answer.

[02:25:38] I'm sorry. So the bill being engrossed and passed the third reading.

[02:25:54] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill being engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker, we come back to a couple of bills that were taken by temporarily. Top of page 25, we've fallen that way. House Bill 1377 is before you. Again, it establishes a task force to determine whether Virginia Military Institute should continue to be a state-sponsored institution of higher education report.

[02:26:15] The Legislation Report Committee on Rules with the Substitute, which has been agreed to. And, Mr. Speaker, the bill's patron, Delegate Helmer, has floor amendments that are available to the public, available to the members here, and are now before the body. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[02:26:31] Mr. Speaker, I move the floor amendments. You've got to move the substitute first. He did. We did that. Oh, we already done that. Okay, good. Okay, the clerk shall report the floor amendments. Floor

amendments, Mr. Speaker, are offered by Delegate Helmer, are available online to the public and members here electronically. on IHOD and are before you.

[02:26:48] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helm. Mr. Speaker. You want to speak to the floor amendments? Yes, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the floor amendments. The floor amendments, first of all, I want to just say how much I appreciate the work with the delegate from Baudetat. We have worked closely with stakeholders to ensure we have an excellent task force that examines education at VMI, the direction of the education, the mechanisms by which it has moved past lost-cost ideology, the quality of the education and officers produced.

[02:27:20] VMI has told us that they're ready to engage and have that conversation and work closely with the task force. And with that, before we adopt the amendments, if it's okay, Mr. Speaker, I'd like to yield my time to the delegate from Bauditeau. The delegate from Bauditeau, Delegate Austin.

[02:27:38] Thank you, Delegate. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, very kindly. Mr. Speaker, HB 1377, as originated, was a bill that had dramatic impacts to VMI.

[02:27:58] I, along with General Furness, appreciate the ability to work with the patron. I personally had conversations with the patron last Friday about some of the language contained herein that brought tremendous concern. The patron indicated the most concerning issues.

[02:28:13] I was then available to convey those back to the institution and arrange a meeting between General Furness and the patron, which has brought to us an agreement and this substitute. At this point in time, the institution understands what changes are desirable and necessary at VMI.

[02:28:37] I'd like to thank the patron and all involved in a willingness to work with us to get this legislation to an agreeable and more favorable posture. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. All. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Floor amendment is agreed to.

[02:28:53] The delegate from Fairfax. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, as amended, House Bill 1377 provides a task force to examine education at VMI, appoints members of this, allows you, Mr. Speaker, to appoint members of the body to the task force and provides that a report will be issued at the end of this year.

[02:29:10] I hope it is will the body to engross the bill as amended and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Others oppose no? Bills are engrossed and passed the third reading. Last bill in this category, Mr. Speaker, went by temporarily earlier, is House Bill 649.

[02:29:29] This is legislation to amend and reenact Section of Dakota-Virginia related to removal of certain signs and advertisements placed within the limits of highways, agreements with local governing bodies, requirements. It's the Legislation Board Committee on Transportation with Amendment Nature Substitute. Mr. Speaker, the bill's patron has floor amendments to the substitute.

[02:29:50] The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Ayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, I also move that the floor amendments be agreed to. And you'd like to speak to those floor amendments?

[02:30:06] I'd like to speak to the floor amendments. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 649 simply ensures that political sign enforcement is carried out only by authorized paid employees of a locality, not by deputized private volunteers.

[02:30:23] We have seen instances, Mr. Speaker, where campaign signs are removed without notice, without documentation of any violation of the law, and without accountability. Political speech deserves a clear and transparent enforcement process.

[02:30:40] This bill restores oversight and protects fairness. The floor amendments limit the legislation to localities within the Planning District 23 with populations of 250,000 to 350,000. And the locality would have a tax increment financing district.

[02:30:59] Mr. Speaker, I ask that the bill be engrossed and moved on to its third reading. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed no. Floor amendment is agreed to. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[02:31:17] Mr. Speaker, that completes that section of the calendar category for the calendar. The final live category, commending resolution of the speaker's tables have been dispensed with. Therefore, Mr. Speaker, there is no further business coming before the House. For House Rule 51, the House is returned to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications?

[02:31:34] No, communications, simply the meeting schedule that's available online this Wednesday, February 4th, Committee on Appropriations Meeting is canceled, but in lieu of that time, it's going to have some of its subcommittees work. Specifically, Appropriations Transportation Public Safety Subcommittee will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House, roughly around 245.

[02:31:57] They'll be up on the 12th floor once that subcommittee is done, then Appropriations, Commerce, Ag, and Natural Resources subcommittee will meet there. So two subcommittees of appropriations starting 15 minutes upon adjournment. The Committee on Finance will meet 15 minutes upon adjournment of the House.

[02:32:16] They'll be in House Room B on the second floor, so that'll be approximately 245 again. Then the Committee for Courts of Justice will meet 15 minutes after adjournment of the Finance Committee.

[02:32:32] They'll be next door in House Committee Room C, and then 15 minutes upon adjournment of that full committee. Its criminal and civil subcommittees will be meeting. The former will be meeting in House Committee Room C. The latter will be in House North Subcommittee on the second floor.

[02:32:49] At 4 o'clock, Committee on Agricultural and National Resources, the Agriculture Subcommittee We'll be meeting there in the House subcommittee room, House South subcommittee room on the second floor, ACNR AG sub on the south. And then also at four transportation committees, Highway and Safety and Policy subcommittee will be meeting down in House Room A.

[02:33:10] And then rounding out the day's activities, the LGBTQIA plus caucus will be meeting at five o'clock today in the House subcommittee room up on the ninth floor. Looking ahead to tomorrow, February 5th, Thursday, February 5th, the Capitol Commission prayer meeting will be at 630 and then the Bible study at 7.

[02:33:29] That's up in the speaker's conference room. The Legislative Sportsman's Caucus is meeting tomorrow at 7 a.m. on the 7th floor, North Subcommittee, obviously 7th floor. At 7.30, the Hampton Roads Caucus is meeting. They will be in the 7th floor South Subcommittee room.

[02:33:48] So, um, Sportsman at 7 in the north and Hampton Roads, uh, in the south and then at 7:30 as well, uh, the concert, uh, conservative energy caucus, excuse me, uh, they're meeting on the ninth floor in that subcommittee room meeting room. Um, tomorrow, CC and T subcommittee two meeting is canceled. Um, so, uh, then, however, uh, CC and T subcommittee number three will be meeting um there at 7:30 in the house sub south subcommittee room on the second floor um also at 7:30 tomorrow health and human services behavioral health subcommittee is meeting at 7:30 they're in

[02:34:26] house committee room c on the second floor then once that subcommittee is finished um or at 8:30 uh the full committee will meet they're in house committee room c and then once the full committee is finished another one of their subcommittees uh hhs health professions subcommittee will meet meeting upon a German. That's all on the second floor, House Room C. I think was mentioned previously, I know the reception tonight, but the Aviation Caucus is meeting tomorrow morning at 8 a.m. in the Senate Subcommittee Room 600 North. So on the sixth floor of the Aviation Caucus tomorrow at 8. Also at 8 tomorrow, Public Safety Committee's Subcommittee No. 2 will be meeting.

[02:35:02] They'll be in the North Subcommittee Room on the second floor. Then at 9, the Committee on Transportation will be meeting on the House Committee Room B on the second floor, then the two caucuses will be meeting, Democrats at 11:15, House Room 1, Republican Caucus at 11:30, and House Room 2.

[02:35:22] Mr. Speaker, that completes all the announcements I have. Delegate from Alexander. Delga Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 12:00 noon. Delegate from Alexander. Delga Herring moves that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene tomorrow at 12:00 noon.

[02:35:37] The motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The delegate from Alexander, the delegate hearing. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexander, the delegate hearing moves that the House do now adjourn. The motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.

